

Content Inventory

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTATION

Revised February 23, 2010



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CHAPTER 1

PROJECT BACKGROUND

Project Overview

This project was included to give Kaplan University a realistic scope of their existing web site content. By performing a Content Inventory, Kaplan will know exactly how many web sites they have at the time, how many pages are in each site, and an idea of how much content is in each one.

What is a Content Inventory?

A Content Inventory is a bird's eye view of how much content is contained in a web site. The term *bird's eye* is used because every page, link and asset within a web site is documented, not every paragraph or word in a page. This is usually done by someone looking at each page in a web site, copying links and images used in each page and organizing them in a spreadsheet application like Excel. The spreadsheet can then be used by various departments and provide valuable information such as:

- How many pages are in a website
- The depth of pages in a website
- Exactly how many images are in a website
- An idea of how much text is contained in a page

With this kind of information on hand, it can allow a department manager to get an idea of content and estimate a realistic timeframe for finishing a project. On the same note it can give a web designer peace of mind by knowing exactly how many pages and images are in a site and what they are working with. This in turn helps the interaction between the department manager and the web designer in terms of getting a project completed.

The Purpose of this Document

There is no "one right way" to perform a Content Inventory. This is because every web site varies in types of content and information that needs to be gathered by the person performing the Inventory. A positive note is that companies usually have a similar structure for the majority of their web sites to maintain consistency and establish their brand. For various departments to get the most out of the information gathered in a Content Inventory, everyone needs to be able to read the spreadsheet and know what it is for. Hence the purpose of this document. In the following pages, the methods used to perform the Content Inventory for Kaplan University will be explained so that when a user looks at a spreadsheet, they can understand how it works and begin to see how it can be useful in various ways.

CHAPTER 2

CONTENT AREA DEFINITIONS

Notes: The circled numbers described in this definition correspond to the *Content Area* number defined in Column A = ID in the excel spreadsheets

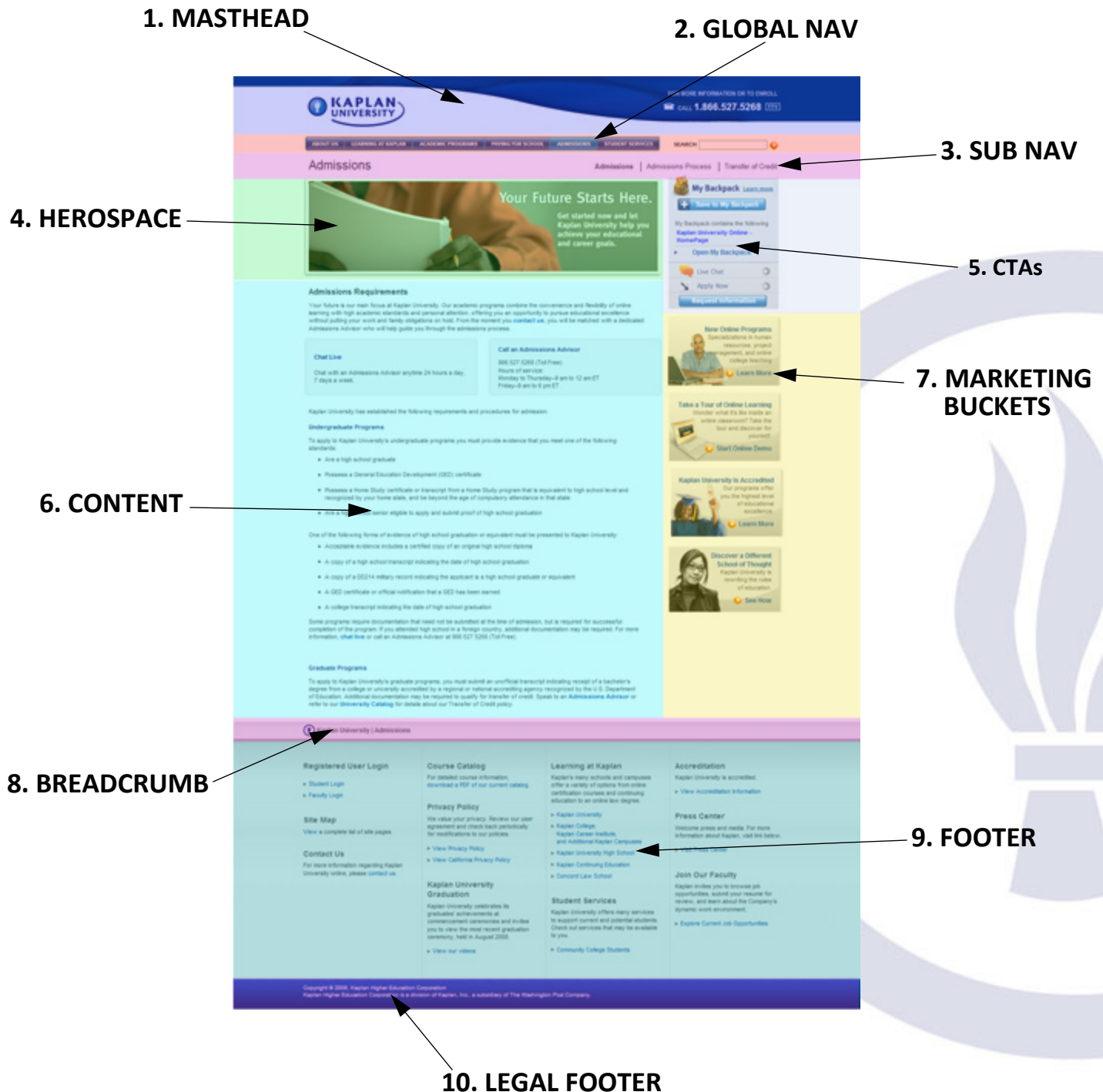
Definition 1 - VERTICAL MARKETING BUCKET LAYOUT

MASTHEAD		①
GLOBAL NAV		②
SUB NAV		③
HEROSPACE	④	⑤
CONTENT	⑥	⑦
	MARKETING BUCKETS	
BREADCRUMB NAV		⑧
FOOTER		⑨
LEGAL FOOTER		⑩

CONTENT AREA DEFINITIONS (CONT.)

Notes: You can use the content area names with a co-worker to make it easier to relate to an area of a website.

Definition 1 Example



CONTENT AREA DEFINITIONS (CONT.)

Notes: Notice how in this layout, the positioning of the Marketing Buckets (7) is displayed horizontally BELOW the content apart from the previous example.

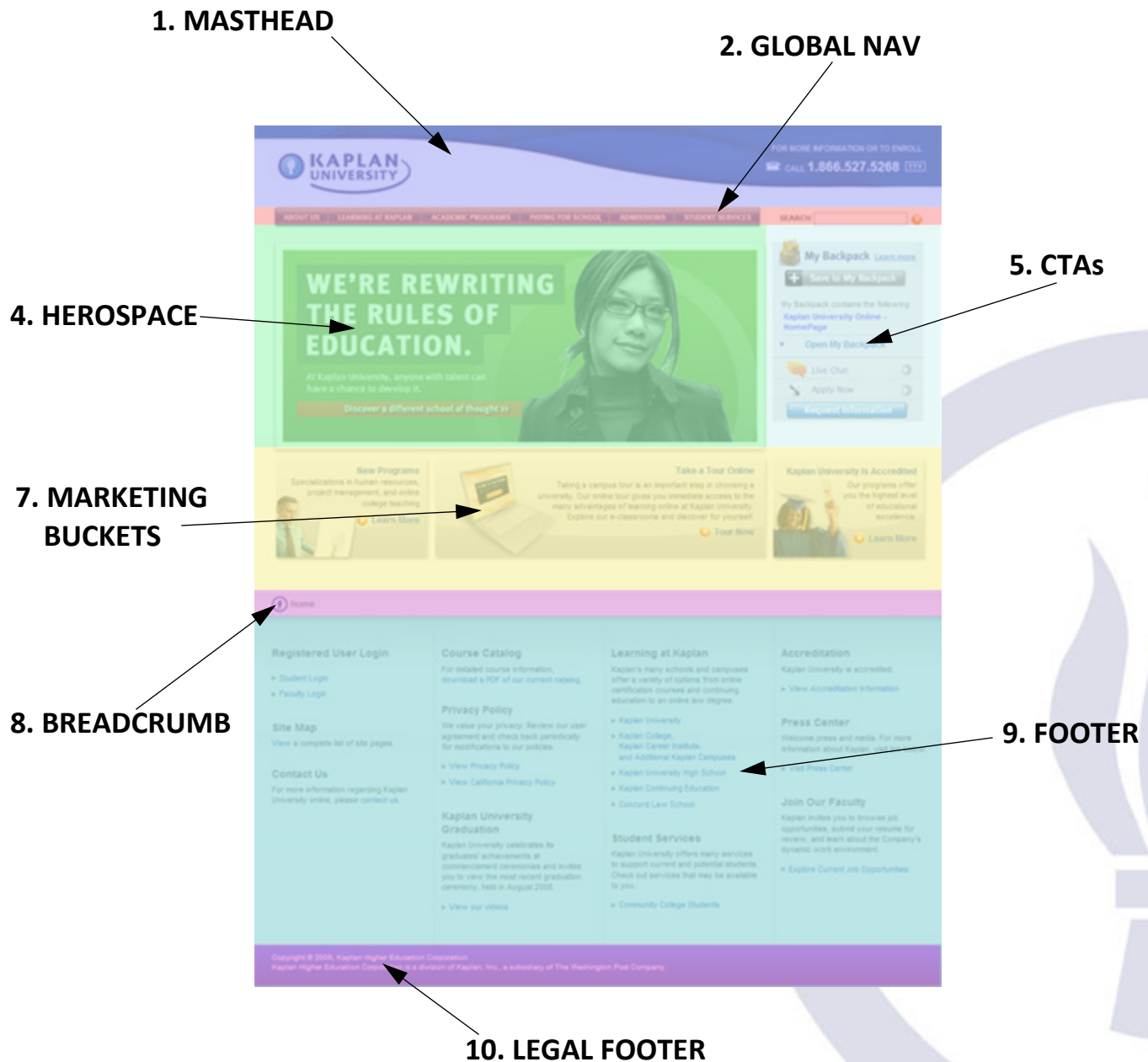
Definition 2 - HORIZONTAL MARKETING BUCKET LAYOUT

MASTHEAD	①
GLOBAL NAV	②
SUB NAV	③
HEROSPACE	④
CTAs	⑤
CONTENT	⑥
MARKETING BUCKETS	⑦
BREADCRUMB	⑧
FOOTER	⑨
LEGAL FOOTER	⑩

CONTENT AREA DEFINITIONS (CONT.)

Notes: Please see the Glossary for terms used throughout this document.

Definition 2 Example



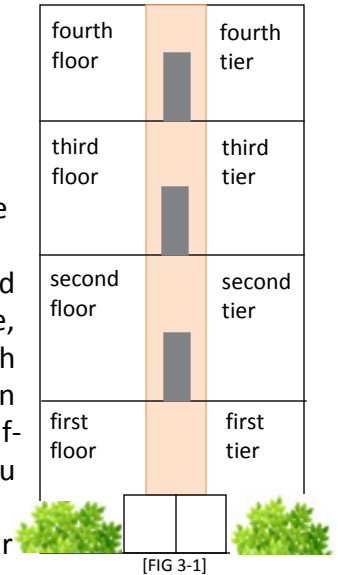
*Note: Sub Nav (3) and Content (6) do not exist on this page.

Chapter 3

TIER DEFINITIONS

What are Tiers?

Compare the tiers in a website to floors in a building [Fig 3-1]. The first tier would be the first floor, with its reception area and visitor information. The first tier is also the basic level of the web site. The second tier would be the second floor, with its own rooms and areas within that floor. Just like a building, the second tier is the next level in a web site, with in-depth information about the content on the first tier. Next is the third tier, which you can think of as the third floor... You can see where this is going. The higher you go in the building, the more you get a sense of the company in the building. Each floor has different departments, which gives you a better idea of how the company is run. When you look at a web site, the more tiers it has, the more in-depth the web site goes to explain the content from each previous tier. Looking at a web site in this way can broaden your understanding of it. You can now use this knowledge in practical ways. For example, a user may determine if the existing content in each tier has been updated, is necessary to keep, or even if that content is no longer needed.



[FIG 3-1]

Take a look at an example of tiers in an actual Kaplan web site:



[Fig 3-2] FIRST TIER WEB PAGE



[Fig 3-4] THIRD TIER WEB PAGE



[Fig 3-3] SECOND TIER WEB PAGE

Chapter 4

SPREADSHEET NUMBERING DEFINITION

Why is there an ID Column?

In a Content Inventory, every link and image is given a unique number. At first glance the ID numbers could look daunting, especially in websites with deep linking. It is not as complicated as one might think, and there is invaluable information to discover in the ID numbers.

The following is a list of ways you could use the IDs in a spreadsheet:

- Assign a developer a range of IDs to migrate in a large website
- Quickly view the names and number of schools described within a website
- Scan web site content
- Delete redundant links
- Find ways to measure analytically
- Quickly scan a spreadsheet before referring to its content in a meeting

In the pages that follow, the numbering system developed for this Content Inventory will be broken into three separate tier examples: a. First Tier, b. Second Tier and c. Third Tier. The number of tiers in a web site could be infinite, but most rarely go beyond the third tier. For this reason, there will be examples of a website running three tiers deep.

Before you continue...

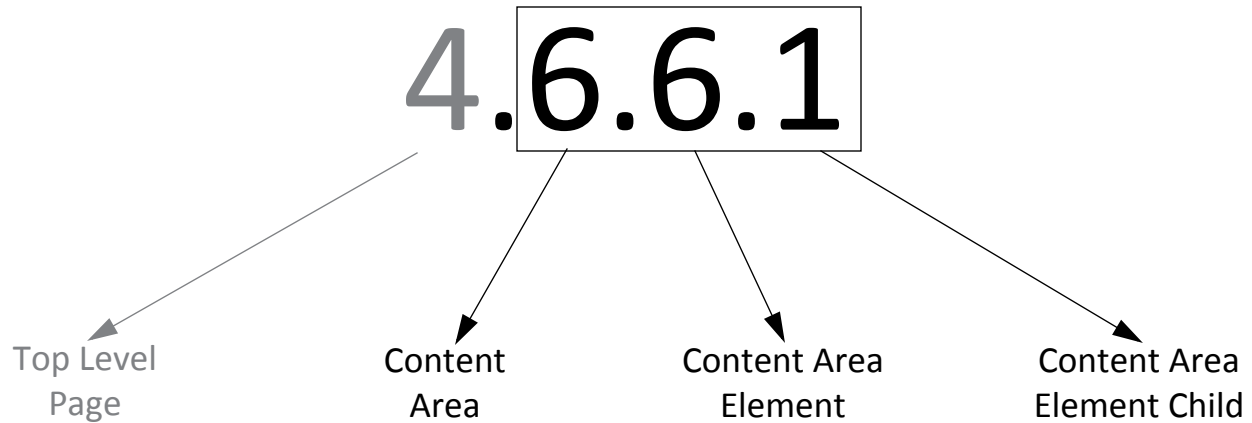
!!IMPORTANT!

You can apply this numbering system to any Kaplan University website that follows a Content Area Definition. ***The only website in this project that has a separate Content Area Definition is portal.kaplan.edu.*** Please refer to the appendices for this unique definition.

SPREADSHEET NUMBERING DEFINITION (CONT.)

Notes: This number is found in the first column of a Content Inventory spreadsheet (**Column A = ID**)
 See glossary for terms used throughout this document.

First Tier Example - (HOME PAGE AND GLOBAL NAV PAGES)



4 = Fourth page in the 1st Tier, which is Academic Programs

6 = Content Area - Content See "[Chapter 2 - Content Area Definitions](#)" on page 2.

6 = 5th link in the Content Area (read left to right), which is "Education"

1 = 1st link within Education (read left to right),
 which is "More Information on the Graduate School of Education"

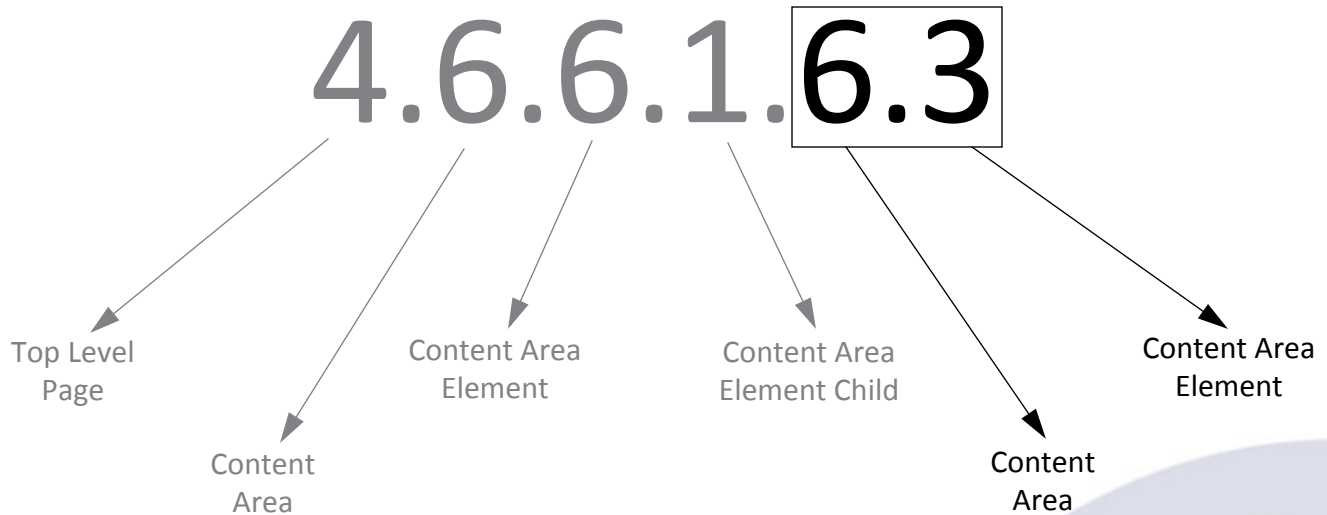
website referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu
spreadsheet referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu_LINKS.xlsx



SPREADSHEET NUMBERING DEFINITION (CONT.)

Notes: This number is found in the first column of a Content Inventory spreadsheet (**Column A = ID**)
See glossary for terms used throughout this document.

Second Tier Example



4 = Fourth page in the 1st Tier, which is Academic Programs

6 = Content Area > Content

6 = 5th link in the Content Area (read left to right), which is “Education”

1 = 1st link within Education, which is “More Info of the Graduate School of Education”

6 = In the 2nd Tier (2nd tab in spreadsheet), Look for the greyed number 4.6.6.1 (reference number), then 6, which is the content area on that page

3 = 3rd link within the Content Area, which is “Master of Arts in Teaching - Iowa Certification”

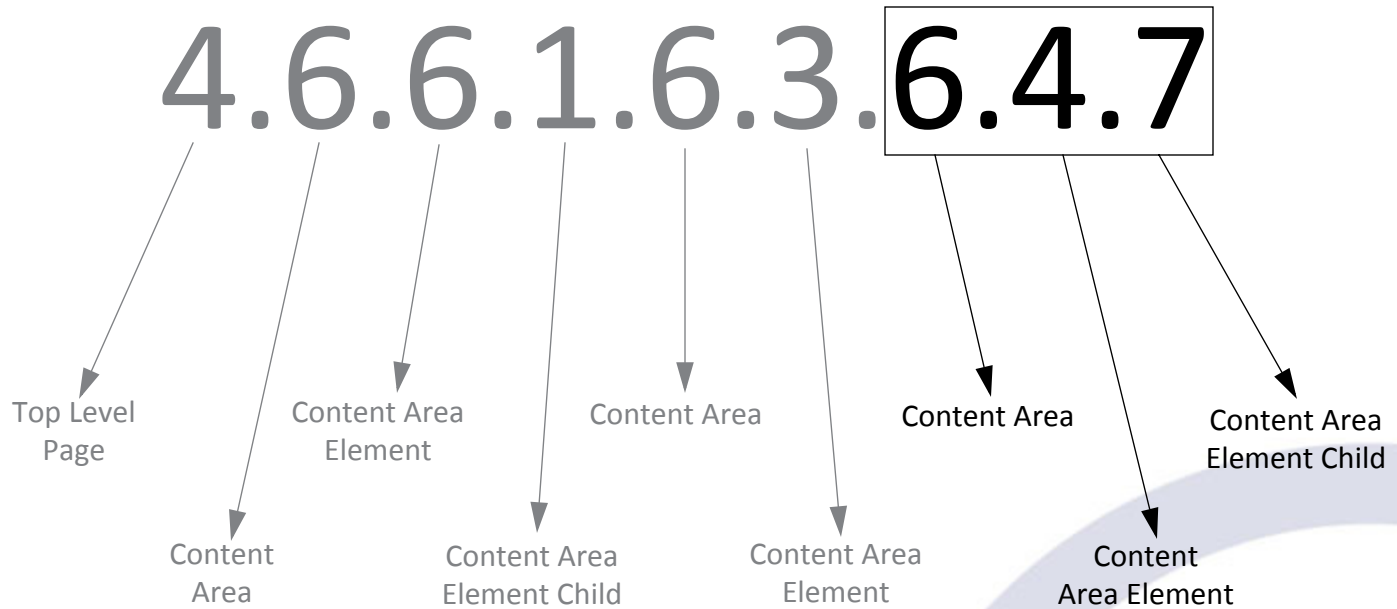
website referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu

spreadsheet referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu_LINKS.xlsx

SPREADSHEET NUMBERING DEFINITION (CONT.)

Notes: This number is found in the first column of a Content Inventory spreadsheet (**Column A = ID**)
See glossary for terms used throughout this document.

Third Tier Example



4 = Fourth page in the 1st Tier, which is Academic Programs

6 = Content Area > Content

6 = 5th link in the Content Area (read left to right), which is “Education”

1 = 1st link within Education, which is “More Info of the Graduate School of Education”

6 = In the 2nd Tier (2nd tab in spreadsheet), Look for the greyed number 4.6.6.1 (reference number), then 6, which is the content area on that page

3 = 3rd link within the Content Area, which is “Master of Arts in Teaching - Iowa Certification”

6 = In the 3rd Tier (3rd Tab in spreadsheet), look for the greyed number 4.6.6.1.6.3 (reference number) and 6, which is the content area on that page

4 = 4th element within the Content Area, which is “Curriculum”

7 = 7th link within Curriculum, which is “perspectives on Diversity”

website referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu

spreadsheet referenced in this example: online.kaplanuniversity.edu_LINKS.xlsx



Chapter 5

DATA CELL DEFINITION

Notes: There are two types of spreadsheets for each website: 1. Links 2. Assets (images)
See glossary for terms used throughout this document.

If there is already content, why should I add more?

The spreadsheets in this project include a basic set of data cells, but you may want to add or remove columns as it pertains to your involvement with a task.

The following lists define the basic data cells that are included in the *links* and *assets* spreadsheets:

LINKS

- ID
- Location (Content Area)
- Link Text
- Link URL
- Opens in new window
- Redirect
- Notes

ASSETS

- ID
- Thumbnail
- Image URL
- Width/Height
- Notes

Examples of how data columns could be added to a spreadsheet:

- If you are a web designer, you could add a **Status** column to keep track of the images you have updated for a web site.
- If you are a developer, you could add a column headed **Migrated** to keep track of completed pages to a new server.
- If metrics applies to you, try grouping a set of links to create a new goal to measure against another group of links within the same site. Document your findings on the spreadsheet.

Other possible uses:

- Import the data from the spreadsheets into a database
- Improve web site optimization by comparing existing use of images

Chapter 6

GLOSSARY

Usage

This glossary is a reference for the terms used in this document.

Anchor – Text or image link on a web page to content within the same page.

Asset – Refers to media files associated with a website including but not limited to images and flash files.

Backpack – Marketing Element created by Kaplan that allows a user to save, e-mail and compare links they want to visit at another time. The backpack feature is similar to a ‘shopping cart’ feature on consumer websites. The backpack will save the link in the element via cookie as long as the user is viewing the website from the same internet browser and computer each time the user visits the site. For example, if the same user viewed the same website on both internet explorer and firefox on the same computer but only saved a link in the backpack in firefox, the saved link will not appear in internet explorer. However, if the user turned off their computer and didn’t return to the site for a week and then viewed the same website again in firefox (where the link was saved earlier), the link would still appear in the backpack. The only way to remove the link is to manually remove the link in the backpack element itself.

Breadcrumb – Text links used to give users a way to keep track of their locations within a website. Displays just above the footer on Kaplan websites.

Content Area – Block of content that holds related elements.

CTA – Call to action. An element specifically created (usually containing a link) to entice the user to complete one of the major goals for visiting the site. (An example could be getting a potential student one step closer to enrolling to Kaplan University)

Element – Individual piece of content containing information on a webpage. For example each link within the global navigation would be one element within that content area.

External Site – In this documentation, link to another website that is not the current website. (Example: google search engine links to a yahoo web page)

Flash Banner – Element that contains image transitions and/or animated content on a website.

Footer – Persistent element that contains important text or links which displays at the bottom of every page in the website. Information in this area should not change per-page.

Global Navigation – Persistent element that contains links to the main 1st tier webpages on a website. Also known as the most basic level of web pages.

Header – Text that describes a content area on a web page to a user.

Herospace – Name for the banner image area under the global navigation on all Kaplan websites. Holds either static images or flash content.

Link – Text or image that is emphasized for the user to click to go to another web page. (May describe the page the user is being redirected to)

GLOSSARY (CONT.)

Link Text – Text on the web page that the user clicks to go to another page on the website.

Link URL – Website address that appears in the navigation toolbar of an internet browser to an individual page on a website.

Location – Content area that element appears on the website.

Marketing Bucket – Kaplan term which is the name for the area on a website dedicated to display promotional material. The location for the marketing buckets is consistent on all websites.

Masthead – Persistent element that usually includes the company logo and contact CTA on the top of every website.

Numbering System (ID Column in spreadsheet) – Numbering system created to establish consistency in referring to individual elements across multiple parties on a website.

Overlay – Information that appears on top of the content on the page the user is viewing.

Page Divider – Dark grey row on spreadsheet that separates 2 or more large content areas on one webpage.

Page Heading – A row used on an excel spreadsheet to make it easier for a reader to separate chunks of related links. Usually has a light blue background.

Persistent Element – Elements and its related content that appear on every page on a website.

Redirect – Link URL that is created to temporarily refer the user to a specific page. Usually created for departmental use within the company for various uses such as TV, print, online or email campaigns.

Sub Navigation – Links that usually appear under the global navigation which lead to webpages related to the page the user is currently viewing.

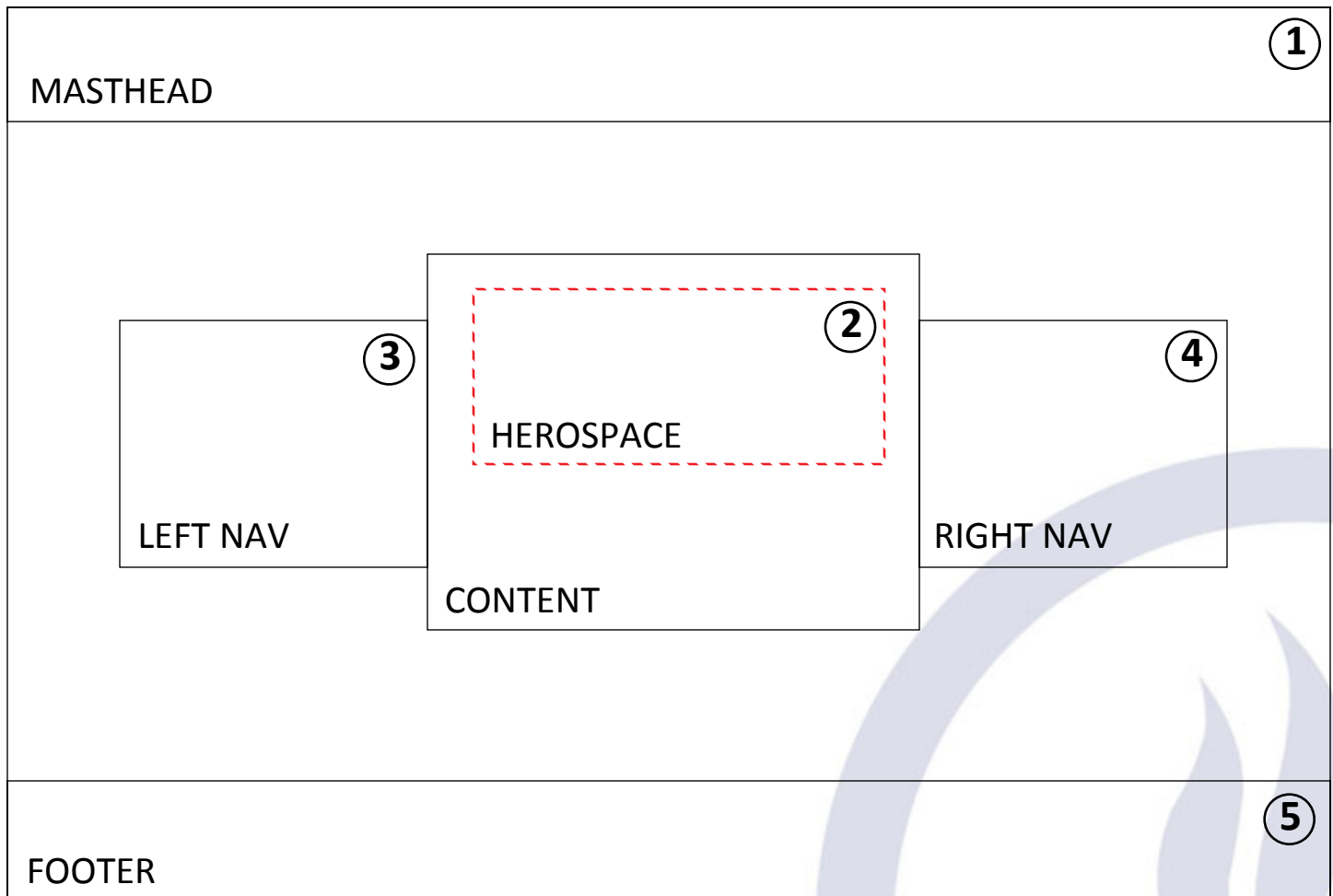
Sub-Page – New web page that is linked from a parent page dedicated to explaining detailed information about a subject on the parent page.

Template – CMS Template being used to hold the content on a web page.

Tiers – Indicates the depth of a page on a website. For example, a page which is linked from the global navigation would be the first tier, and a link from that page to a new page containing detailed related content would be the 2nd tier, and so on. (*see Tier Visual Definition for additional reference*)

Appendices

Unique Content Area Definition for portal.kaplan.edu



Why this definition is unique: portal.kaplan.edu is a flash web site that was developed with its own look and feel separate from the other Kaplan web sites, which all share the same underlying look and feel.

End of Document

